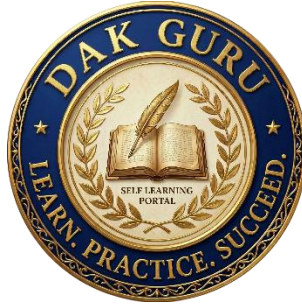




# DAK GURU

SMART SELF-PREPARATION PORTAL

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## POST OFFICE GUIDE

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### PART II

*Rules & Regulations Relating to Foreign (International) Post*

**Comprehensive Study Material**

for the LDCE — Inspector of Posts (IP) & PS Group 'B' Examinations

#### UPDATED EDITION

Incorporating the Post Office Act 2023, the Post Office Rules 2024 & Regulations 2024 (Schedule III tariffs; amended to the Sixth Amendment, w.e.f. 01.01.2026), the 28th UPU Congress (Dubai, 2025) & the latest DoP rationalisation orders.

Compiled & by [www.dakguru.com](http://www.dakguru.com)

## Disclaimer & About This Material

### DISCLAIMER

This study material has been prepared purely as an educational aid for candidates preparing for the Limited Departmental Competitive Examinations (LDCE) of the Department of Posts. It is an original compilation written in the Dak Guru house style and is **not** an official publication of the Department of Posts, the Universal Postal Union, or any Government authority.

Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy by verifying content against primary sources — the Post Office Act 2023, the Post Office Rules 2024, the **Post Office Regulations 2024 (including Schedule III — Postage and Fee for International Items)** as amended, official India Post notifications, Department of Posts office memoranda, Press Information Bureau releases, and Universal Postal Union publications. All slabs, rates and fees in this edition are drawn from **Schedule III of the Post Office Regulations 2024**. The position of law and tariffs is stated **as available up to the date of compilation (June 2026)**.

**Postal rules, tariffs, SDR conversion rates and service availability change frequently.** Candidates must always cross-check the current position against the latest departmental orders, gazette notifications and the official India Post website ([www.indiapost.gov.in](http://www.indiapost.gov.in)) before relying on any figure for the examination or for official work. Where a figure could not be independently confirmed from a primary source, this has been flagged in the text.

Wherever a conflict exists between older departmental manuals (including the printed Post Office Guide Part II) and the **Post Office Act 2023 / Rules 2024 / Regulations 2024**, the latter — being the current governing framework — shall prevail.

## How to Use This Material

This booklet rewrites and updates the Post Office Guide Part II, which deals exclusively with **Foreign (International) Post** — the rules governing letters, parcels and special services exchanged between India and other countries. The material is arranged into five sections that mirror the structure of the subject:

- **Section I — General:** definitions, the Universal Postal Union (UPU) and the Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU).
- **Section II — General Regulations in the Letter Post:** classes of letter-post articles, rates, registration, prepayment, detention and customs formalities.
- **Section III — Conditions for Various Classes of Letter-Post Items:** weight and size limits, printed papers and the M-Bag (Bulk Bag) system.
- **Section IV — Special Services in the Letter Post:** air mail and aerogrammes, advice of delivery, insurance, International Reply Coupons and the International Tracked Packet Service.
- **Section V — Parcel Post:** dimensions, weight, customs documents, redirection, insurance and compensation.

Each topic is followed by a **Points to Remember** box capturing the examination-critical facts, and important changes are highlighted in **Latest Update** boxes. A set of **Multiple Choice Questions** with an answer key appears at the end. Read the prose first, absorb the boxes, then test yourself with the MCQs.

### A NOTE ON RECENT CHANGES — READ FIRST

The international letter-post landscape changed significantly at the turn of 2026. With effect from **1 January 2026**, the Department of Posts **discontinued several outward international letter-mail services** — most importantly the **Registered Small Packet service** and the **outward Small Packet service** for goods (by Sea, SAL or Air), along with the **Surface** and **Surface Air-Lifted (SAL) Letter Mail** services for outward letters. As a result, the printed Post Office Guide Part II (and older notes) — which describe Small Packets and surface/SAL letter mail as routine services — are **partly out of date for outward mail**. This material retains those topics for completeness and for inward mail, but clearly flags what has been withdrawn. **Study the Latest Update boxes carefully**, as the examiner may test the new position.

# Section I

## General

### Foreign (International) Post — Foundational Concepts

#### 1.1 Meaning of “Foreign Post”

The term **foreign post** (also called **international post**) applies to those postal services that do **not** fall within the definition of **inland post**. In simple terms, foreign post covers the carriage of postal articles between India and other countries or territories. The legal basis for India’s international postal cooperation flows from the **Post Office Act 2023** and the **Post Office Rules 2024**, under which the Central Government provides services in furtherance of international postal cooperation, in conformity with the Universal Postal Union (UPU) Convention, its Manuals and Regulations, and bilateral or multilateral agreements in force.

**Source / Authority:** *Post Office Rules 2024 (G.S.R. 767(E), w.e.f. 16.12.2024), Rules 3 & 12; Post Office Act 2023 (Act 43 of 2023). The Rules 2024 supersede the Indian Post Office Rules 1933.*

#### 1.2 The Two Categories of Foreign Postal Articles

Postal articles exchanged in foreign post are broadly divided into **two categories**:

1. **Letter Post** (also called *correspondence*) — letters, postcards, aerogrammes, printed papers, literature for the blind, M-Bags and the International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS).
2. **Parcel Post** — international air parcels, international surface air-lifted (SAL) parcels and international surface parcels.

In addition, the **Express Mail Service (EMS / International Speed Post)** is the fastest service for sending documents and merchandise worldwide. India Post’s basic international letter services are available for **219 destinations** across the globe.

**Source / Authority:** *India Post — International Mail Products (indiapost.gov.in/mailproducts/internationalservices).*

### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Foreign post = all postal services **not** covered by the definition of inland post.
- Foreign postal articles fall into **two** categories: **Letter Post** and **Parcel Post**.
- Letter Post (correspondence) now formally includes **ITPS**; Parcel Post includes air, SAL and surface parcels.
- **EMS (International Speed Post)** is the fastest international service for documents and merchandise.
- International letter services are available to **219 destinations** worldwide.
- The governing framework is the **Post Office Act 2023 + Rules 2024 + Regulations 2024**, read with the **UPU Convention**.

## The Universal Postal Union (UPU)

The **Universal Postal Union (UPU)**, established in **1874**, is a **specialised agency of the United Nations** responsible for the postal sector. Headquartered in the Swiss capital **Berne (Bern)**, it is one of the oldest international organisations in the world. With its **192 member countries**, the UPU is the primary forum for cooperation between postal-sector players. It helps ensure a truly universal network of up-to-date products and services, fulfilling an advisory, mediating and liaison role and providing technical assistance where needed. It **sets the rules for international mail exchanges** and makes recommendations to stimulate growth in mail, parcel and financial-services volumes and to improve quality of service for customers.

**Source / Authority:** *Universal Postal Union (upu.int); India Post International Mail Products. India joined the UPU in 1876.*

## 2.1 The Four Bodies of the UPU

The UPU functions through **four** bodies:

1. **The Congress** — the **supreme authority** of the UPU. It meets **every four years** and is attended by plenipotentiaries of all member countries; it sets policy and adopts the UPU Strategy.
2. **The Council of Administration (CA)** — ensures the continuity of the UPU's work between Congresses, supervises its activities and studies regulatory, administrative, legislative and legal issues.
3. **The Postal Operations Council (POC)** — the technical and operational mind of the UPU; it deals with operational, economic and commercial aspects of international postal services.
4. **The International Bureau (IB)** — fulfils a **secretariat** function, providing logistical and technical support to the UPU's bodies. It is headed by the **Director General** (currently **Mr. Masahiko Metoki**).

## 2.2 The Latest Universal Postal Congress

### LATEST UPDATE — 28th UPU Congress

The **28th Universal Postal Congress** was held in **Dubai, United Arab Emirates**, from **8 to 19 September 2025**. It was attended by representatives of the UPU's **192 member countries**.

The Congress adopted the **UPU Strategy 2026–2029 (the “Dubai cycle”)**, along with a new Integrated Remuneration System for 2026–2030 and reforms to better separate **goods from documents** in international mail for the e-commerce era.

**Note for the examination:** older notes refer to the **27th Congress (Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire, 2021)** as the latest. That is now superseded. The **next (29th) Congress is scheduled for 2029** (host yet to be decided).

### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- UPU established in **1874**; HQ at **Berne, Switzerland**; a **specialised agency of the UN**.



- UPU has **192 member countries**. India joined in **1876**.
- UPU has **four bodies**: Congress, Council of Administration, Postal Operations Council, International Bureau.
- The **Congress** is the supreme authority and meets **every 4 years**.
- Latest Congress: **28th UPU Congress, Dubai, 8–19 September 2025** (adopted the Strategy 2026–2029).
- Director General of the International Bureau: **Mr. Masahiko Metoki**.

## The Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU)

The **Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU)** is an inter-governmental organisation of **32 member countries** of the Asia-Pacific region. It is the **only Restricted Union** of the UPU in the region (Restricted Unions are permitted under Article 8 of the UPU Constitution). The goal of the APPU is to **extend, facilitate and improve postal relations** between member countries and to promote cooperation in the field of postal services.

The history of the APPU dates back to a postal round-table held in **Manila in 1961**, where 18 countries drew up the Asian-Oceanic Postal Convention (which came into force on 1 April 1962). The union in its **present form** was constituted by the **Asian-Pacific Postal Convention signed at Yogyakarta on 27 March 1981**. India joined the APPU in 1973.

The APPU was based in **Manila** for the first four decades in recognition of the Philippines Government's role in its formation. **Since 2002 the headquarters moved to Bangkok, Thailand**. At the **Tehran Congress (2017)**, the office of **Director** was redesignated as **Secretary-General**, who now heads the Union for a four-year term and also serves as Director of the Asian-Pacific Postal College.

*Source / Authority: APPU Bureau ([appu-bureau.org](http://appu-bureau.org)); UPU Restricted Unions; PIB. Convention signed at Yogyakarta, 27.03.1981.*

### 3.1 The Three Bodies of the APPU

1. **The Congress** — the supreme body of the Union.

2. **The Executive Council (EC)** — comprises all member countries; it lays down operational rules and supervises the Bureau between Congresses.
3. **The APPU Bureau** — the secretariat and liaison/training arm, based in Bangkok, comprising an administrative section and a training section (the **Asian-Pacific Postal College, APPC**, founded in 1970).

### **LATEST UPDATE — Indian leadership of the APPU**

Following elections at the **13th APPU Congress (Bangkok, 2022)**, **Dr. Vinaya Prakash Singh** of India took charge as **Secretary-General of the APPU in January 2023** for a four-year term. This is the **first time an Indian** is heading an international organisation in the postal sector.

### **POINTS TO REMEMBER**

- APPU = inter-governmental body of **32 member countries**; the **only Restricted Union** of the UPU in the region.
- Origins: Manila round-table, **1961**; Asian-Oceanic Postal Convention in force **1 April 1962**.
- Present form by the **Asian-Pacific Postal Convention, Yogyakarta, 27 March 1981**.
- **India joined APPU in 1973**.
- HQ: **Bangkok, Thailand** (since 2002; earlier Manila).
- Three bodies: **Congress, Executive Council, APPU Bureau** (which runs the APPC, founded 1970).
- Head is the **Secretary-General** (designation since the Tehran Congress, 2017). Current SG: **Dr. Vinaya Prakash Singh** (India), since Jan 2023.



## Section II

### *General Regulations Applicable in the Letter Post*

#### Classes of Letter-Post Articles

In the foreign post the term “**Letter Post**” (also referred to as **correspondence**) applies to the following classes of postal articles:

- **Letters**
- **Postcards**
- **Printed Papers** (including books)
- **Literature for the Blind** (Blind Literature)
- **Small Packets** (*see Latest Update — outward service largely withdrawn from 01.01.2026*)
- **M-Bags** (Bulk Bags of printed matter)
- **International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS)**

**Aerogrammes** are also part of the letter post — a category intended for transmission exclusively by air.

**Source / Authority:** India Post International Mail Products; Post Office Regulations 2024 (as amended).

#### **LATEST UPDATE — Withdrawal of Small Packet & Surface/SAL letter mail (outward), w.e.f. 01.01.2026**

By a Department of Posts decision effective **1 January 2026**, in line with UPU decisions and global best practice, the following **outward** international letter-mail services were **discontinued**:

- **Registered Small Packet service** — UPU now restricts registration to **document-only** items.
- **Outward Small Packet service** — including letter-post items containing **goods** sent by **Sea, SAL or Air**.
- **Surface Letter Mail Service** and **Surface Air-Lifted (SAL) Letter Mail Service** for outward letter-post items.

After rationalisation, **registration continues for documents only**, booked in **Air mode**, under the categories of **Letters, Postcards, Printed Papers, Aerogrammes, Blind Literature and M-Bags**. Existing UPU provisions for **Blind Literature and M-Bags continue unchanged**.

Customers wishing to send **goods** abroad are directed to the **International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS)** and other international **parcel** services, which provide end-to-end tracking. (The corresponding **Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations 2025**, in force 01.01.2026, omitted references to “small packets” from several regulations and schedules.)

**Source / Authority:** PIB Press Release PRID 2209903, Ministry of Communications; Post Office (Sixth Amendment) Regulations 2025 (in force 01.01.2026).

### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Letter post = Letters, Postcards, Printed Papers, Blind Literature, Small Packets, M-Bags and **ITPS**.
- **Aerogrammes** are part of the letter post (air-only category).
- From **01.01.2026**, the **outward Small Packet service** (for goods) and **registered Small Packets** stand **discontinued**, as do **Surface / SAL outward letter mail** services.
- Registration now applies to **documents only**, in **Air mode**: Letters, Postcards, Printed Papers, Aerogrammes, Blind Literature, M-Bags.
- **Blind Literature & M-Bag** provisions continue **unchanged**.

## Maximum Weights & Rates of Postage

### 5.1 Maximum Weight Limits

The principal maximum weight limits in the international post are:

| Article / Service | Maximum Weight |
|-------------------|----------------|
| Letters           | 2 kg           |
| Printed Papers    | 2 kg           |
| Small Packets     | 2 kg           |

| Article / Service              | Maximum Weight |
|--------------------------------|----------------|
| Literature for the Blind       | 7 kg           |
| M-Bags (Bulk Bags)             | 30 kg          |
| Aerogramme                     | 3 grams        |
| Parcels (general limit)        | 20 kg          |
| EMS / International Speed Post | 35 kg          |

These are the **general** maxima; the actual limit for any destination is the **lower** of the general limit and the maximum weight that the destination country accepts.

**Source / Authority:** India Post International Mail Products; UPU Letter Post & Parcel Post Regulations.

## 5.2 Rates of Postage — Letter Post (Surface)

### **IMPORTANT — Tariffs are statutory; GST applies separately**

The tariffs below are reproduced from **Schedule III, Table I of the Post Office Regulations 2024** (the current statutory schedule for international items), and **GST is levied over and above the tariff. Always confirm the current amount** using the official **postage calculator at [indiapost.gov.in](https://indiapost.gov.in)** before quoting a figure. Remember also that the **outward Small Packet service for goods stands withdrawn from 01.01.2026**.

These are the **surface** rates (where postage is prepaid). For air transmission, the **air surcharge** in Para 6.2 is added; for the (now-withdrawn outward) SAL mode, the SAL fee in Para 6.2 applied.

### (a) Letters

| Destination                 | Weight Slab                         | Rate (₹) |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------|
| U.S.A.                      | Up to first 20 g                    | 32       |
| U.S.A.                      | Each additional 20 g (up to 2000 g) | 22       |
| All countries except U.S.A. | Up to first 20 g                    | 25       |
| All countries except U.S.A. | Each additional 20 g (up to 2000 g) | 15       |

### (b) Printed Papers

| Destination                 | Weight Slab                         | Rate (₹) |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------|
| U.S.A.                      | Up to first 20 g                    | 35       |
| U.S.A.                      | Each additional 20 g (up to 2000 g) | 25       |
| All countries except U.S.A. | Up to first 20 g                    | 27       |
| All countries except U.S.A. | Each additional 20 g (up to 2000 g) | 17       |

**(c) Small Packets (outward goods service withdrawn w.e.f. 01.01.2026 — shown for reference)**

| Destination                 | Weight Slab                          | Rate (₹) |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------|
| U.S.A.                      | Up to first 100 g                    | 115      |
| U.S.A.                      | Each additional 100 g (up to 2000 g) | 105      |
| All countries except U.S.A. | Up to first 100 g                    | 80       |
| All countries except U.S.A. | Each additional 100 g (up to 2000 g) | 70       |

**(d) Postcards (Single, Surface) & Blind Literature**

| Article / Destination                                      | Rate (₹)      |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Postcard (single) — Pakistan, Nepal, Bangladesh, Bhutan    | 8             |
| Postcard (single) — APPU countries (except the four above) | 10            |
| Postcard (single) — UPU countries (except APPU countries)  | 12            |
| Blind Literature packet — all countries                    | Exempt (free) |

**(e) Airmail Postcard & Aerogramme (Table V)**

| Article / Destination                                  | Rate (₹) |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Airmail Postcard — Pakistan, Nepal, Bangladesh, Bhutan | 10       |
| Airmail Postcard — Other countries                     | 15       |
| Aerogramme — for all countries                         | 20       |

**Blind Literature** sent by or addressed to a blind person or an organisation for the blind is **exempt from postage**, except applicable **air surcharges**, subject to destination-country regulations.

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Tables I & V; PIB PRID 2209903 (blind-literature exemption).

## M-Bag Postage, Air Surcharge & Registration Fee

### 6.1 Postage on an M-Bag of Printed Matter

The following rates of postage are chargeable on the **gross weight** of an M-Bag of printed matter (for all countries) when postage is prepaid:

| Article | Weight Slab                                  | Rate (₹) |
|---------|----------------------------------------------|----------|
| M-Bag   | For weight not exceeding 5 kg                | 700      |
| M-Bag   | Per kg (or part) exceeding 5 kg, up to 30 kg | 150      |

### 6.2 Surface Air-Lifted (SAL) Fee & Air Surcharge — by Sector

The Regulations prescribe **two distinct** add-on charges, both levied **per 20 g (or part)** in addition to the normal surface rate. **Note the difference** — the air-surcharge rates (Table IV) are higher than the SAL rates (Table III):

**(i) SAL Fee — Table III (outward SAL letter mail withdrawn w.e.f. 01.01.2026; retained for context)**

| Sector (Destination Region)            | SAL Fee per 20 g (₹) |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Countries in Asia                      | 3                    |
| Countries in Europe                    | 4                    |
| Countries in Africa                    | 4                    |
| Countries in North America & Australia | 7                    |
| Countries in South America             | 9                    |

**(ii) Air Surcharge — Table IV (added for items sent by air)**

| Sector (Destination Region)            | Air Surcharge per 20 g (₹) |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Countries in Asia                      | 4                          |
| Countries in Europe                    | 5                          |
| Countries in Africa                    | 5                          |
| Countries in North America & Australia | 8                          |
| Countries in South America             | 10                         |

**Reminder:** the dedicated **Surface** and **SAL Letter Mail** services for **outward** letters were **discontinued from 01.01.2026**; outward letter mail now moves in **Air mode** (Table IV air surcharge applies). Both tables are retained to show the distinction and for inward/legacy context.

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Tables III (SAL) & IV (Air surcharge).

**6.3 Registration Fee**

Registration provides a record of posting and limited compensation. The current registration charges are:

| Article                                                                          | Registration Fee (₹) |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Letters, Postcards, Aerogrammes, Printed Papers, Small Packets, Blind Literature | 150 per article      |
| M-Bag of Printed Matter                                                          | 750 per bag          |

Registration charges are payable **over and above** the applicable postage. The **registered M-Bag** service is **not accepted by Canada and the U.S.A.** From **01.01.2026**, registration is available for **documents only**, booked in **Air mode**.

**Source / Authority:** India Post — International Mail Products (registration ₹150 / M-Bag ₹750; not accepted by Canada & USA); PIB PRID 2209903. (No fee for registration of blind literature — Reg. 113.)

**POINTS TO REMEMBER**

- Max weights: Letters/Printed Papers/Small Packets **2 kg**; Blind Literature **7 kg**; M-Bag **30 kg**; Aerogramme **3 g**; Parcel **20 kg**; EMS **35 kg**.
- M-Bag postage: **₹700** up to 5 kg; **₹150** per kg (or part) beyond 5 kg up to 30 kg.

- **SAL fee** per 20 g (Table III): Asia ₹3; Europe/Africa ₹4; N. America & Australia ₹7; S. America ₹9.
- **Air surcharge** per 20 g (Table IV): Asia ₹4; Europe/Africa ₹5; N. America & Australia ₹8; S. America ₹10.
- Airmail Postcard: ₹10 (Pak/Nepal/B'desh/Bhutan) / ₹15 (others). **Aerogramme** ₹20 (all countries).
- Registration fee: ₹150 per article; ₹750 per M-Bag (over and above postage). No fee for blind-literature registration.
- **Registered M-Bag is not accepted by Canada and the U.S.A.**
- From 01.01.2026 registration is for **documents only**, in **Air mode**.

## Prepayment, Delivery & Withdrawal

### 7.1 Manner of Prepayment of Postage

Postage may be **prepaid in cash** at certain important post offices specially authorised for the purpose, where a sender wishes to post a large number of **unregistered** packets. A minimum of **500 packets in big cities** and **250 in small towns** must be posted at a time to avail of this facility. Certain post offices in **Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Nagpur and Delhi** are also authorised to realise postage and registration fee on ordinary **registered** articles of letter mail in cash, provided the sender uses special registered journals and the number at one time is **not less than 50**.

### 7.2 Delivery in the Country of Destination

Articles are delivered in the country of destination according to that country's **internal legislation and regulations**, which vary widely from country to country. The Indian Postal Department is **not responsible** for the manner in which an article is delivered, or returned undelivered, if this is done in accordance with the laws of the destination country.



### 7.3 Withdrawal from Post & Alteration of Address (Recall)

Under **Regulation 55** of the Post Office Rules/Regulations 2024, the sender of an item — for **accountable domestic items and international inward items** — may avail, **without** reference to or consent of the addressee, the facility of **(a) recall** of the item from the post, or **(b) alteration** in the address or name of the addressee. The applicable **fee is ₹6 per item** (Schedule I, Table VI — Redirection). Recall may be exercised so long as the item has not been despatched / delivered. Where the **addressee** seeks alteration of address and the original and substitute addresses are within the **same post office's delivery area**, the alteration is **free of charge**; otherwise the ₹6 fee applies. A receipt is given for the fee.

#### **CORRECTION — Recall fee is now ₹6, not ₹30**

The older printed Post Office Guide Part II quotes a recall fee of **₹30 (in postage stamps) with a sealed cover of reasons**. Under the **current Post Office Regulations 2024 (Regulation 55 read with Schedule I, Table VI)**, the fee chargeable for **recall, or alteration in address/name**, is **₹6 per item**. Follow the current figure.

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Regulation 55; Schedule I, Table VI (Redirection) — fee ₹6 per item.

#### **POINTS TO REMEMBER**

- Cash prepayment for **unregistered** packets: minimum **500 (big cities) / 250 (small towns)** at a time.
- Cash realisation for **registered** letter-mail articles allowed at certain POs in **Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Nagpur, Delhi**, when not less than **50** at a time.
- India is **not liable** for the manner of delivery abroad if done per destination-country law (Reg. 122).
- Recall / alteration of address (Reg. 55): fee **₹6 per item** (Schedule I, Table VI) — **not** the old ₹30. Free if the addressee alters within the same PO's delivery area.

## Detention, Armed-Forces Mail & Customs Formalities

### 8.1 Period of Detention & Demurrage (Warehousing) Charges

Under **Schedule III, Table XI** of the Post Office Regulations 2024, a **demurrage (warehousing) charge of ₹10 per day** is levied — commencing from the **eighth day** — on an inward international **packet (or bag) of printed papers**, an inward international **small packet**, or an inward international **insured letter / insured box**, where it **weighs more than 500 g** and the addressee fails to take delivery within **seven days** of first presentation (or intimation of arrival). The same ₹10-per-day charge applies to such articles addressed “**Poste Restante**.” No warehousing charge is levied on **letters and postcards**.

#### **CORRECTION — Inward demurrage is ₹10/day (not ₹5/day)**

Older notes (and the printed Guide) quote **₹5 per day** for inward printed-paper / small-packet / insured articles above 500 g. The **current Post Office Regulations 2024 (Schedule III, Table XI)** prescribe **₹10 per day**, commencing the eighth day. For **international air parcels**, the demurrage is **₹1 per day** (subject to a maximum of **₹24.50**; for air parcels addressed “Poste Restante,” maximum **₹40**). Follow these current figures.

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Table XI (Demurrage): inward packets >500 g ₹10/day; air parcel ₹1/day.

### 8.2 Correspondence for Indian Armed Forces Serving Abroad

Articles for the personnel of the **Indian Armed Forces serving outside India** should be addressed to **56 APO** or to the **Fleet Mail Office, Mumbai**. Such articles are **prepaid at inland rates** and are treated as **inland articles for all purposes**. They are **not exempt** from postal charges.

### 8.3 Customs Declarations on Outward Articles (CN22 / CN23)

Items containing **goods/dutiable contents** and all small packets must be accompanied by **customs declaration forms** (specified by the UPU). Under **Regulation 120(3)**, the form depends on the declared value:

1. **Form CN22** — where the declared value of the international item is **less than or equal to 300 SDR**.
2. **Form CN23** — where the declared value is **greater than 300 SDR**.

In addition, the sender of international mail containing **merchandise** must provide **KYC / e-KYC** documents, and **Electronic Advance Data (EAD)** — the **7+1 dataset** (consignor & consignee name/address, number of packages, total gross weight, merchandise description and an identifier) — may be required by the destination country. Letters, postcards, printed papers (other than books) and items for the blind, not subject to customs duty, are **exempt** from EAD requirements.

**Source / Authority:** *Post Office Regulations 2024, Regulation 120 (EAD, CN22 ≤ 300 SDR / CN23 > 300 SDR, 7+1 dataset, KYC).*

### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Demurrage (Table XI): inward printed-paper/small-packet/insured article >500 g = **₹10/day** from the **8th day**; **none** on letters & postcards.
- International **air parcel** demurrage: **₹1/day** (max **₹24.50**); air parcel “Poste Restante” max **₹40**.
- Armed-Forces mail abroad → **56 APO** or **Fleet Mail Office, Mumbai**; prepaid at **inland rates**, treated as inland; **not** exempt from charges.
- Customs forms (Reg. 120): **CN22** (value ≤ **300 SDR**) and **CN23** (value > **300 SDR**).
- Merchandise senders need **KYC/e-KYC**; **EAD 7+1 dataset** may be required; ordinary correspondence/blind items are **EAD-exempt**.
- Unpaid/insufficiently-paid items (Table X): charged **double the prepaid rate / double the deficiency** (min ₹1).

## Section III

### Conditions Relating to Various Classes of Letter-Post Items

#### Weight & Size Restrictions

##### 9.1 Weight Limits

| Article                                   | Maximum Weight |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Letters, Printed Papers and Small Packets | 2 kg           |
| Items for the Blind (Blind Literature)    | 7 kg           |
| M-Bags (Bulk Bags)                        | 30 kg          |

##### 9.2 Size Limits — Items other than Postcards & Aerogrammes

###### Maximum

- Length, width and depth **combined: 900 mm**, but the **greatest dimension may not exceed 600 mm** (tolerance 2 mm).
- In roll form:** length plus twice the diameter = **1,040 mm**, but the greatest dimension may not exceed **900 mm** (tolerance 2 mm).

###### Minimum

- A surface measuring **not less than 90 × 140 mm** (tolerance 2 mm).
- In roll form:** length plus twice the diameter = **170 mm**, but the greatest dimension may not be **less than 100 mm**.

##### 9.3 Size Limit — Postcard

The size of a postcard is **14 cm × 9 cm** (length × breadth).

**Source / Authority:** UPU Letter Post Regulations; India Post International Mail Products (size limits).

#### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Weight: Letters/Printed Papers/Small Packets **2 kg**; Blind items **7 kg**; M-Bags **30 kg**.

- Max (flat):  $L+W+D = 900 \text{ mm}$ , greatest dimension  $\leq 600 \text{ mm}$ .
- Max (roll): length +  $2 \times \text{diameter} = 1,040 \text{ mm}$ , greatest dimension  $\leq 900 \text{ mm}$ .
- Min (flat): surface  $\geq 90 \times 140 \text{ mm}$ . Min (roll): length +  $2 \times \text{diameter} = 170 \text{ mm}$ , greatest dimension  $\geq 100 \text{ mm}$ .
- Postcard size:  $14 \text{ cm} \times 9 \text{ cm}$ .

## Printed Papers & the M-Bag (Bulk Bag) System

### 10.1 Printed Paper Service

The “**Printed Paper**” service in the foreign post corresponds to the “**Book Packet**” service in the inland post, with some variation in conditions. Printed Paper was earlier available for two categories — **ordinary printed papers** and **registered newspapers** — but the “**Registered Newspaper**” sub-service has since been **discontinued**. (Under the new framework, matters relating to registered newspapers are aligned with the **Press and Registration of Periodicals Act 2023**; existing registrations may continue until renewal.)

### 10.2 The Bulk Bag System (now the M-Bag / Mail Bag)

The **Bulk Bag** system — now referred to as the **M-Bag (Mail Bag)** — is available for the despatch and receipt of special bags of **printed papers** to and from a **single addressee at the same address** in foreign countries. Printed papers for the same addressee may be inserted in one or more special bags. The bags must be so closed as to allow the post office to inspect the contents. Key conditions:

- Each bag must weigh **not less than 5 kg and not more than 30 kg**.
- The **registration charge** for an M-Bag of printed matter is **₹750**.
- Application for the **M-Bag facility** must be made to the **Head of the Circle**, through the post office where it is proposed to post.

**Reminder:** existing UPU provisions for **M-Bags continue unchanged** after the 01.01.2026 rationalisation.

**Source / Authority:** *Post Office Guide Part II; PIB PRID 2209903 (M-Bags unchanged); Press & Registration of Periodicals Act 2023.*

**POINTS TO REMEMBER**

- Foreign **Printed Paper** ↔ inland **Book Packet**.
- The **Registered Newspaper** sub-service has been **discontinued**.
- **Bulk Bag = M-Bag (Mail Bag)**: for printed papers to a **single addressee** at the same address.
- Each M-Bag: **min 5 kg, max 30 kg**; registration charge **₹750**.
- Apply for M-Bag facility to the **Head of the Circle** through the posting office.
- M-Bag provisions **continue unchanged** post-01.01.2026.



## Section IV

### *Conditions Relating to Various Special Services in the Letter Post*

## Air Mail, L.C./A.O. Classification & Aerogrammes

### 11.1 Air Mail & Surcharges (General)

Except for a few countries, air mails in the international post are subject to **additional surcharges** or **special combined air-cum-postage charges**. For the purpose of surcharges, articles are broadly divided into **two groups**, commonly known by their French names:

1. **L.C. (Lettres et Cartes** — meaning “**Letters and Cards**”) — letters and postcards.
2. **A.O. (Autres Objets** — meaning “**Other Objects**”) — printed papers, small packets, blind literature, etc.

### 11.2 Aerogrammes

An **aerogramme** is a category intended for transmission **exclusively by air** and has **no corresponding category** in the surface mail. (If it is transmitted by surface for any reason, it is treated as a **letter**.) An aerogramme should **not weigh more than 3 grams**.

### 11.3 Advice of Delivery (A.R.)

The sender of a **registered** article may obtain an **Advice of Delivery** — similar to the “acknowledgement” in the inland post — by paying the requisite additional fee. The indication “**Avis de réception**” (Advice of Delivery), or the stamp impression **A.R.**, should be made in **bold letters on the address side**.

**Source / Authority:** UPU Convention (LC/AO; AR); Post Office Guide Part II. ‘Avis de réception’ = Advice of Delivery.

#### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Surcharge groups: **L.C. (Lettres et Cartes = Letters and Cards)** and **A.O. (Autres Objets = Other Objects)**.
- **Aerogramme:** air-only; treated as a **letter** if sent by surface; **max 3 g**.



- **Advice of Delivery:** marked “**Avis de réception**” / **A.R.** in bold on the address side; available for **registered** articles on extra fee.

## Liability, Insurance & Compensation (Letter Post)

### 12.1 Special Drawing Rights (SDR)

Compensation in the international post is expressed in **Special Drawing Rights (SDR)** — an international reserve asset created by the **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** in **1969**. The SDR is **not a currency** but a **unit of account** based on a basket of **five major currencies**: the **U.S. dollar**, **Euro**, **Chinese Renminbi (Yuan)**, **Japanese Yen** and **British Pound Sterling**. The value of the SDR is calculated **daily** by the IMF and the SDR–INR rate is revised by the Postal Directorate **annually**.

#### **IMPORTANT — SDR conversion rate is revised annually; confirm before use**

The official India Post international-mail page states **1 SDR = ₹109.4194 (for 2024)**. Some secondary compilations cite **1 SDR ≈ ₹117.88 (for 2025)**; this figure **could not be confirmed** against a primary Directorate notification at the time of compilation. **Treat the SDR–INR rate as approximate and verify** the prevailing rate from the latest Directorate order before applying it.

**Source / Authority:** India Post International Mail Products (1 SDR = ₹109.4194 for 2024); IMF (SDR basket). 2025 figure unverified.

### 12.2 Compensation for Registered Letter-Post Articles

Under **Schedule III, Table IX of the Post Office Regulations 2024** (which reflects the revised compensation policy of **29.04.2022**, applicable to items booked **on or after 01.05.2022**), the compensation for **outbound** international registered articles booked in India is as follows:

| Event                                                  | Compensation Payable                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Loss / total theft / total damage of a Registered Item | The <b>declared value</b> of contents or <b>30 SDR, whichever is less</b> , plus the postage paid |

| Event                                                           | Compensation Payable                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Loss / total theft / total damage of a Registered M-Bag         | 150 SDR (plus postage)                                                                                                  |
| Partial loss / partial damage / partial theft (Registered Item) | Limited to the <b>declared value</b> of the lost/damaged content (not exceeding the above); postage <b>not</b> refunded |

**No indemnity** is payable beyond these limits. Enquiry about an international registered article may be made **free of charge**.

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Table IX; DoP O.M. CF-71/29/2021-CF-DOP dated 29.04.2022; India Post — International Mail Products.

### 12.3 Compensation for EMS & ITPS (Letter Post)

**EMS (International Speed Post)** is India's fastest international service for documents and merchandise (**Regulation 118**), charged on a **first 250 g + each additional 250 g** basis (Schedule III, Table VII). The revised compensation policy (now reflected in **Schedule III, Table IX** of the Regulations 2024) provides:

- **EMS — Merchandise:** declared value of contents or **130 SDR**, whichever is less, plus postage paid.
- **EMS — Documents:** limited **only to the postage paid**.
- **EMS — delay:** if delivery is delayed beyond **5 days** of the declared standard (excluding holidays), compensation of **5% of the postage paid** is payable.
- **ITPS:** restricted to **₹1,000** or the actual declared value of the contents lost/damaged, whichever is less.

**EMS — sample postage (Schedule III, Table VII; first 250 g / each additional 250 g):**

| Destination   | Documents — First 250 g (₹) | Addl. 250 g (₹) | Merchandise — First 250 g (₹) |
|---------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------|
| U.S.A.        | 1820                        | 150             | 1820                          |
| Great Britain | 1965                        | 90              | 1965                          |
| Canada        | 1180                        | 180             | 1180                          |
| Australia     | 1125                        | 230             | 1125                          |
| Singapore     | 1175                        | 65              | 1175                          |

| Destination | Documents — First 250 g (₹) | Addl. 250 g (₹) | Merchandise — First 250 g (₹) |
|-------------|-----------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------|
| Japan       | 700                         | 80              | 945                           |
| Bangladesh  | 765                         | 50              | 765                           |
| Nepal       | 670                         | 40              | 670                           |

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Tables VII (EMS rates) & IX (compensation); DoP O.M. 29.04.2022. Rates illustrative; verify on [indiapost.gov.in](https://indiapost.gov.in).

## 12.4 Insurance of Letters

Among the various letter-post categories, **only letters** can be sent **insured** in the foreign post, and only to **selected countries**. The maximum amount for which a letter may be insured varies according to the **destination and the route**, but the insurance amount can **never exceed the limit adopted for the inland post**.

It is also permissible to insure a letter for the **inland transit only**, where insurance service is not available in the destination country. Such a letter is treated as an **insured letter while in transit within India** and as a **registered letter beyond the limits of India**; the Post Office's liability for any loss then depends on **where the loss occurs**.

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Guide Part II; Post Office Regulations 2024 (insurance). Only letters are insurable in letter post.

### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- **SDR** = IMF unit of account (since **1969**); basket of **5** currencies: **USD, EUR, CNY, JPY, GBP**.
- Official rate: **1 SDR = ₹109.4194 (2024)** — verify the current Directorate rate before use.
- Registered item (loss/total): **declared value or 30 SDR, whichever is less + postage**.
- Registered **M-Bag** (loss/total): **150 SDR**.
- EMS merchandise: **declared value or 130 SDR, whichever is less + postage**; EMS documents: **postage only**; EMS delay (>5 days): **5% of postage**.
- **ITPS**: **₹1,000** or actual declared value, whichever is less.

- Only **letters** can be **insured** in the letter post; insurance limit  $\leq$  **inland limit**; inland-only insurance possible.
- EMS charged per **first 250 g + each addl. 250 g**; ITPS per **first 100 g + each addl. 100 g** (Schedule III).

## International Reply Coupons & International Tracked Packet Service

### 13.1 International Reply Coupons (IRC)

The **International Reply Coupon (IRC)** allows a person sending a letter to another country to **pre-pay the postage for the reply**. When the sender writes to a foreign addressee and wants a response, they may purchase an IRC and enclose it with the letter. The IRC entitles the addressee to **one or more return postage stamps** representing the minimum postage for an unregistered priority item or airmail letter to a foreign country. In short, the stamps obtained in exchange for IRCs are used by the addressee to reply to the sender.

### 13.2 International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS)

The **International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS)** is specially designed to cater to the needs of **e-commerce** for sending shipments, principally to the **Asia-Pacific region**. Under **Regulation 116**, the Circle Head is authorised to operate the service. The general maximum weight limit is **5 kg**, subject to the maximum acceptable weight of the destination country, whichever is **lower**.

- **Postage structure:** charged on a **first 100 g** slab plus **each additional 100 g** (or part) — see the sample rates below (Schedule III, Table VIII).
- **Compensation:** restricted to **₹1,000** or the **actual declared value** of the contents lost/damaged, **whichever is less**.
- **Coverage:** ITPS is presently available to a defined list of countries (about **41** destinations are listed in the current schedule).

**ITPS — sample postage (Schedule III, Table VIII):**

| Destination              | First 100 g (₹) | Each addl. 100 g (₹) |
|--------------------------|-----------------|----------------------|
| United States of America | 550             | 45                   |
| Australia                | 425             | 45                   |
| Canada                   | 400             | 35                   |
| Great Britain            | 360             | 25                   |
| Germany                  | 290             | 25                   |
| Singapore                | 355             | 25                   |
| China                    | 305             | 20                   |
| Bhutan                   | 350             | 20                   |

With the **01.01.2026 rationalisation**, the Department of Posts actively encourages customers wishing to send **goods** abroad to use **ITPS and other parcel services** — which provide **end-to-end tracking**, faster delivery and better customs compliance — in place of the withdrawn small-packet services.

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Regulation 116 & Schedule III, Table VIII (ITPS rates); PIB PRID 2209903. Rates are illustrative; verify on [indiapost.gov.in](https://indiapost.gov.in).

**POINTS TO REMEMBER**

- IRC lets the sender pre-pay the **reply** postage; exchangeable for return postage stamps abroad.
- ITPS (Reg. 116): e-commerce shipments to the **Asia-Pacific**; max weight **5 kg**; charged per **first 100 g + each additional 100 g**.
- ITPS compensation: **₹1,000** or actual declared value, whichever is less.
- ITPS promoted as the alternative to the withdrawn small-packet services (end-to-end tracking).

## Section V

### Parcel Post

## Foreign Parcels — Agreements, Postage & Dimensions

### 14.1 Governing Agreement

The **International Parcel Post Service** with most countries is regulated on the basis of the **Universal Postal Union Parcel Post Agreement** (and India's bilateral arrangements). Under the **Post Office Regulations 2024 (as amended by the Sixth Amendment, w.e.f. 01.01.2026)**, in the international post "parcel post" includes international air parcels, surface air-lifted (SAL) parcels and surface parcels. Parcels are made **compulsorily accountable with track-and-trace** features.

### 14.2 Postage & a Key Feature

The rates of postage on foreign parcels are closely related to the actual cost of handling and conveyance and **vary considerably** for different parts of the world. A defining feature: **a foreign parcel is always registered.**

### 14.3 Dimensions

#### Maximum

- **Length must not exceed 1.05 metres.**
- The sum of the **length and the greatest circumference** (measured in a direction other than the length) must **not exceed 2 metres.**

#### Minimum

- A parcel must have a surface measuring **not less than 90 mm × 140 mm.**

### 14.4 Limits of Weight

The general maximum weight limit for a parcel is **20 kg**, subject to the maximum acceptable weight prescribed by the destination country, whichever is **lower.**

**Source / Authority:** UPU Parcel Post Agreement; India Post; Post Office Regulations 2024 (Reg. 107, as amended w.e.f. 01.01.2026).



**POINTS TO REMEMBER**

- International parcels governed by the **UPU Parcel Post Agreement**; “parcel post” includes **air parcels** (Reg. 107, amended 01.01.2026).
- A **foreign parcel is always registered**; parcels are **track-and-trace** accountable.
- Max length **1.05 m**; length + greatest girth  $\leq 2$  m; min surface **90 × 140 mm**.
- General max weight **20 kg** (or the destination-country limit, whichever is lower).

## Booking Documents, Undelivered Parcels & Redirection

### 15.1 Documents at the Time of Booking

A foreign parcel must **always** be accompanied by a **customs declaration** and a **despatch note**. The customs forms are the same as in the letter post:

1. **CN22** — for articles of value **below SDR 300**.
2. **CN23** — for articles of value **SDR 300 or above**.

### 15.2 Undelivered Inward Parcels — Detention & Demurrage

If the addressee fails to take delivery within **seven days** following the date of first presentation (or the date of intimation of arrival), a **demurrage charge** is collected from the addressee **commencing from the eighth day**. Under **Schedule III, Table XI**, the demurrage for an **international air parcel** is **₹1 per day** (subject to a maximum of **₹24.50**); for an air parcel addressed “**Poste Restante**,” the maximum is **₹40**. Such parcels — **except VP parcels** — are detained for a period **not exceeding one month** at the office of delivery; **VP parcels** addressed “Poste Restante” are detained for only **seven days**.

#### Customs Clearance Fee (Table XII)

Where an inward international item is released after levying customs duty, a **customs-clearance fee of ₹30**, recoverable from the addressee, is charged for **each foreign letter packet or insured box**, and for **each foreign parcel or bulk bag of printed matter weighing more than 500 g**.



**Source / Authority:** *Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Table XI (air-parcel demurrage ₹1/day) & Table XII (customs clearance ₹30).*

### 15.3 Redirection

An inward foreign parcel may be **redirected** (only on the **written instruction** of the addressee or agent). Redirection to another place in India attracts a **redirection fee** calculated on weight at **half the rates of postage** for parcels — except where the original and substituted addresses are within the delivery area of the **same post office** or the **same post town**. An inward parcel may also be **redirected outside India** if it satisfies the conditions for onward transmission and the service is available; the additional postage (equal to the postage on a parcel of the same weight to the new destination) is normally collected from the addressee, but may be prepaid by the agent in India.

**Source / Authority:** *Post Office Guide Part II; UPU Parcel Post Regulations. Warehousing from the 8th day; redirection at ½ postage.*

#### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Booking documents: **customs declaration + despatch note**; forms **CN22 ( $\leq 300$  SDR)** and **CN23 ( $> 300$  SDR)**.
- Air-parcel demurrage (Table XI): **₹1/day** (max **₹24.50**) from the **8th day**; “Poste Restante” max **₹40**.
- Detention: non-VP **up to 1 month**; VP “Poste Restante” **7 days**.
- Customs-clearance fee (Table XII): **₹30** per letter packet/insured box, and per parcel/bulk bag **>500 g**.
- Redirection within India: **½ the parcel postage** (free if within the same PO/post town); redirection abroad allowed with additional postage.

## Air Parcels, Insurance & Compensation (Parcel Post)

### 16.1 Air Parcels

Air-Parcel service is available for **certain countries** only (**Regulation 117**). Air parcels must bear, on the **top left-hand corner** of the address side, the special **blue airmail label** with the indication “**Par Avion — By Air Mail.**” Postage is charged on a **first 250 g + each additional 250 g** basis (Schedule III, Table VI).

**Air Parcel — sample postage (Schedule III, Table VI; first 250 g / each additional 250 g):**

| Destination              | First 250 g (₹) | Each addl. 250 g (₹) |
|--------------------------|-----------------|----------------------|
| United States of America | 955             | 175                  |
| Great Britain            | 1470            | 125                  |
| Australia                | 1005            | 170                  |
| Canada                   | 1125            | 165                  |
| China                    | 860             | 85                   |
| Singapore                | 825             | 70                   |
| Sri Lanka                | 610             | 45                   |
| Nepal                    | 550             | 40                   |

**Source / Authority:** Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Table VI (Air Parcel rates). Rates illustrative; verify on [indiapost.gov.in](https://indiapost.gov.in).

### 16.2 Insurance of Parcels

- **Insured parcels:** foreign parcels to certain countries may be **insured for their entire transmission**; the limit varies with the country and route.
- **Insurance for inland transit:** parcels to countries where insurance is not available may be insured for the **inland transit alone** (covering risk only within India).
- **Compulsory insurance:** parcels containing coins, bank/currency notes, securities payable to bearer, platinum bullion, precious stones, jewellery, or articles **wholly or partly of gold or silver** are accepted **only if insured**. If the destination country has no insured-parcel service, the parcel must be insured for the **inland transit**.

- **Insured value:** a parcel may be insured for a value **not exceeding** the country's insurance limit and **not exceeding** the actual value of the contents. Foreign parcels posted at **branch offices** cannot be insured for more than **₹600**.

Export and import of gold, currency notes and coins is permitted **only under licence** from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

### 16.3 Compensation for Loss, Theft or Damage of Parcels

Under **Schedule III, Table IX of the Post Office Regulations 2024** (revised compensation policy of 29.04.2022; items booked on/after 01.05.2022), compensation for an **outbound international parcel** booked in India is:

**Loss / total theft / total damage of an International Parcel:** 40 SDR per item + 4.5 SDR per kg, or the **declared value** of the contents, **whichever is less**, subject to an **upper ceiling of 130 SDR**, plus the postage paid.

**Partial loss / damage / theft:** limited to the **declared value** of the lost or damaged content (not exceeding the above); the **postage is not refunded**.

**Note on figures:** older notes often state only “up to 40 SDR per parcel and 4.50 SDR per kg.” The current schedule adds the “**whichever is less**” test (against declared value) and the **130 SDR ceiling** — study the full formulation above.

**Source / Authority:** *Post Office Regulations 2024, Schedule III, Table IX; DoP O.M. CF-71/29/2021-CF-DOP dated 29.04.2022.*

#### POINTS TO REMEMBER

- **Air parcels** bear the **blue “Par Avion — By Air Mail”** label, top-left of the address side.
- Parcels insurable for **entire transit or inland transit only**; **compulsory insurance** for coins, currency, bullion, jewellery, gold/silver articles.
- Branch-office parcels: insurable up to **₹600** only.
- Gold/currency/coin export-import: **only under RBI licence**.
- Parcel compensation: **40 SDR + 4.5 SDR/kg or value, whichever is less, ceiling 130 SDR + postage**.

# Self-Assessment

## Important Multiple Choice Questions

### Important Multiple Choice Questions

Attempt the following questions after studying the material. The answer key follows. These questions reflect the **current** position (including the changes effective 01.01.2026); be alert to the difference between the old and new positions, as either may be tested.

**Q1.** “Lettres et Cartes” (L.C.) means —

- (A) Letters and Cards
- (B) Letter Cart
- (C) Letter Carriage
- (D) Letter Carrier

**Q2.** As on date, the Universal Postal Union (UPU) has how many member countries?

- (A) 191
- (B) 192
- (C) 193
- (D) 194

**Q3.** The two customs declaration forms used in the foreign post are —

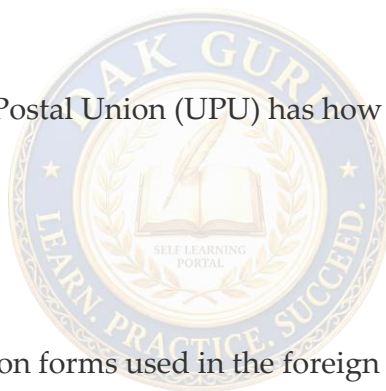
- (A) CN-21 and CN-22
- (B) CN-22 and CN-23
- (C) CN-23 and CN-24
- (D) CN-24 and CN-25

**Q4.** Per Regulation 120 of the PO Regulations 2024, Form CN23 is required where the declared value is —

- (A) Less than or equal to 300 SDR
- (B) Greater than 300 SDR
- (C) Less than 100 SDR
- (D) Exactly 300 SDR

**Q5.** Articles (except VP) addressed “Poste Restante” are charged after 7 days and detained for —

- (A) 15 days



- (B) 1 month
- (C) 45 days
- (D) 3 months

**Q6.** For an item other than a postcard/aerogramme in roll form, the greatest dimension may not exceed —

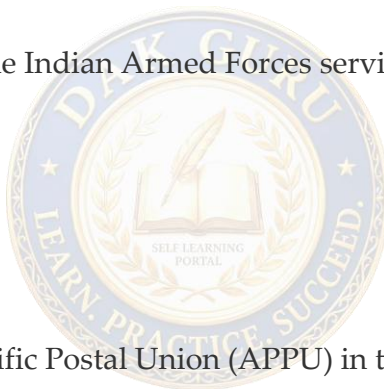
- (A) 350 mm
- (B) 600 mm
- (C) 750 mm
- (D) 900 mm

**Q7.** The stamp impression “A.R.” / “Avis de réception” on a foreign article indicates —

- (A) Advice of Delivery
- (B) Acknowledgement Registered
- (C) Acknowledgement Received
- (D) Article Returned

**Q8.** Articles for personnel of the Indian Armed Forces serving outside India should be addressed to —

- (A) 56 APO
- (B) 99 APO
- (C) Army Base Circle
- (D) Either of the above



**Q9.** India joined the Asian-Pacific Postal Union (APPU) in the year —

- (A) 1970
- (B) 1973
- (C) 1975
- (D) 1979

**Q10.** The 28th Universal Postal Congress (2025) was held at —

- (A) Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire
- (B) Berne, Switzerland
- (C) Dubai, U.A.E.
- (D) Bangkok, Thailand

**Q11.** The maximum weight of an aerogramme is —

- (A) 2 grams
- (B) 3 grams
- (C) 5 grams

(D) 10 grams

**Q12.** The headquarters of the UPU is located at —

- (A) Bangkok
- (B) Berne
- (C) Geneva
- (D) Vienna

**Q13.** The registration fee for an M-Bag of printed matter is —

- (A) ₹150
- (B) ₹250
- (C) ₹500
- (D) ₹750

**Q14.** With effect from 1 January 2026, which outward service was discontinued by the Department of Posts?

- (A) Aerogramme service
- (B) Registered Small Packet service
- (C) M-Bag service
- (D) Blind Literature service

**Q15.** For an International Registered Article, the compensation for total loss is —

- (A) A flat 30 SDR
- (B) Value of contents or 30 SDR, whichever is less, plus postage
- (C) 40 SDR + 4.5 SDR per kg
- (D) ₹1,000 only

**Q16.** Under Schedule III of the PO Regulations 2024, the demurrage on an inward international packet of printed papers (over 500 g) is, from the 8th day —

- (A) ₹1 per day
- (B) ₹5 per day
- (C) ₹10 per day
- (D) ₹15 per day

**Q17.** The general maximum weight limit for the International Tracked Packet Service (ITPS) is —

- (A) 2 kg
- (B) 5 kg
- (C) 10 kg
- (D) 20 kg

**Q18.** The APPU has its headquarters at —

- (A) Manila
- (B) Bangkok
- (C) New Delhi
- (D) Tokyo

**Q19.** The maximum length of a foreign parcel must not exceed —

- (A) 1.00 metre
- (B) 1.05 metres
- (C) 1.50 metres
- (D) 2.00 metres

**Q20.** Under the Post Office Regulations 2024, the fee for recall or alteration of address of an item is —

- (A) ₹6 per item
- (B) ₹15 per item
- (C) ₹30 per item
- (D) ₹50 per item

**Q21.** The Special Drawing Right (SDR) was created by the IMF in the year —

- (A) 1944
- (B) 1969
- (C) 1974
- (D) 1981



**Q22.** Among the letter-post categories, which can be sent insured in the foreign post?

- (A) Postcards
- (B) Printed papers
- (C) Only letters
- (D) Small packets

**Q23.** Per Schedule III of the PO Regulations 2024, the postage for an Aerogramme (all countries) is —

- (A) ₹10
- (B) ₹15
- (C) ₹20
- (D) ₹25

**Q24.** Export and import of gold, currency notes and coins is permitted only under a licence from —



- (A) SEBI
- (B) RBI
- (C) Customs Department
- (D) Ministry of Finance

**Q25.** The current Secretary-General of the APPU (since January 2023) is —

- (A) Masahiko Metoki
- (B) Dr. Vinaya Prakash Singh
- (C) Bishar A. Hussein
- (D) Vineet Pandey

## Answer Key

1-A 2-B 3-B 4-B 5-B 6-D 7-A 8-A 9-B 10-C 11-B 12-B 13-D  
14-B 15-B 16-C 17-B 18-B 19-B 20-A 21-B 22-C 23-C 24-B 25-B

### KEEP YOUR PREPARATION CURRENT

Postal rules and tariffs change often. Before the examination, re-check any figure or service status against the latest **Department of Posts orders, gazette notifications** and the official **India Post website ([www.indiapost.gov.in](http://www.indiapost.gov.in))**. When older manuals conflict with the **Post Office Act 2023 / Rules 2024 / Regulations 2024**, follow the latter.

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— End of Post Office Guide Part II —

**Win the Race.**